SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #83 · PRAYER

“Asking God more than once shows a lack of faith.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Teaching that you should pray once and then “claim it.” Fear that repeating a request shows doubt. Feeling like a nuisance to God. A family where asking twice was seen as nagging. Confusion about how to keep praying without anxiety.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus encouraged persistent prayer. He told a parable so that His followers would pray at all times and not lose heart. He said, “Ask… seek… knock,” words that suggest continuing. In Gethsemane, Jesus prayed a third time, saying the same thing. Paul pleaded with the Lord three times about his thorn. Asking again is not a lack of faith; it shows you are depending on God.

> *“Then Jesus told them a parable about their need to pray at all times and not lose heart”* **(Luke 18:1)**.

Also see

> “So I tell you: Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives; he who seeks finds; and to him who knocks, the door will be opened” **(Luke 11:9–10)**.

> “So He left them and went away once more and prayed a third time, saying the same thing” **(Matthew 26:44)**.

> “Three times I pleaded with the Lord to take it away from me. But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” **(2 Corinthians 12:8–9)**.

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” **(Philippians 4:6–7)**.

Common self-statements

- I already asked, so asking again shows doubt.
- God is tired of hearing about this.
- I should just trust and stop asking.
- Repeating myself is nagging God.
- If I believed, once would be enough.
- God will be annoyed if I keep praying.

Common logical errors

- **Projection:** Picturing God as annoyed, like an impatient person.
- **Should statements:** “I should only need to ask once.”
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking Scripture’s encouragement to keep asking.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing persistence and faith cannot go together.

Challenging questions

- Why did Jesus tell the parable in Luke 18?
- What do “ask, seek, knock” suggest about continuing?
- How many times did Jesus pray the same prayer in Gethsemane?
- How many times did Paul ask about his thorn?
- Is God annoyed by His children, or does He welcome them?
- Can I keep asking while trusting God?
- What request do I need to keep bringing to Him?

Truth summary

> Asking God more than once does not show a lack of faith. Jesus told me to keep praying and not lose heart. He Himself prayed the same prayer three times. God welcomes my persistent prayers. I can keep bringing my requests to Him with thanksgiving and trust Him with the answer.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prayer, How to
- Prayer, Answers to
- Faith
- Trust
- Impatient

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Prayer

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Asking God more than once shows a lack of faith"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Asking God more than once shows a lack of faith." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Why did Jesus tell the parable in Luke 18?
- ☐ What does "ask, seek, knock" suggest?
- ☐ How often did Jesus pray in Gethsemane?
- ☐ How often did Paul ask about his thorn?
- ☐ Is God annoyed by His children?
- ☐ What request should I keep bringing?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus told me to keep praying and not lose heart.
- ☐ Asking again shows I depend on God.
- ☐ God welcomes my persistent prayers.
- ☐ I can keep asking, seeking, and knocking.
- ☐ I can bring my requests with thanksgiving.
- ☐ God's peace guards my heart as I pray.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Luke 18:1**
  "Then Jesus told them a parable about their need to pray at all times and not lose heart."
- [ ] **Luke 11:9–10**
  "So I tell you: Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened to you. For everyone who asks receives; he who seeks finds; and to him who knocks, the door will be opened."
- [ ] **Matthew 26:44**
  "So He left them and went away once more and prayed a third time, saying the same thing."
- [ ] **2 Corinthians 12:8–9**
  "Three times I pleaded with the Lord to take it away from me. But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- [ ] **Philippians 4:6–7**
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Persistent prayer list:** Each day, pray for my ongoing requests and mark the date. Note any changes.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.

  *For example, Philippians 4:6–7 becomes: "**Sarah** can be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present **her** requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard **her** heart and **her** mind in Christ Jesus."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Prayer, Answers to" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Make a list of ongoing requests** and pray through it each morning for a week.
- ☐ **Read Luke 11:5–13 and 18:1–8,** and write what Jesus says about persistence.
- ☐ **Each time you pray again,** add one thing you are thankful for.
- ☐ **Ask a friend to pray persistently with you** about one request.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Asking God more than once shows a lack of faith": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	I prayed for my ongoing requests
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Asking God more than once shows a lack of faith.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You welcome my prayers again and again. Help me reject the lie that asking more than once shows a lack of faith. Teach me to keep praying and not lose heart, to bring my requests with thanksgiving, and to trust Your timing. In Jesus' name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.